

Call for Expressions of Interest

<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Untitled Elephant Game
<i>Company:</i>	University of Nottingham

Contact Details

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Additional Info

<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☐
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☐
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐ If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Human computer interaction, games

Project Background Information

For this project, you will build a multiplayer game for multiple computers which are in the same place, e.g. for multiple laptops in a lab.

Each laptop will have its own (3rd person) view onto the play field, which contains a herd of elephants. The 3rd person views will be set up to match the real-world location of the laptops, so each player will only be able to see part of the play field, and will have to cooperate with (i.e. shout at) the other players when action occurs outside their view.

You will build some kind of puzzle or action game which involves getting the herd of elephants to do some task or behave in some way. I am envisaging something either like Lemmings (where you create obstacles or provide tools which redirect the elephants to do what you want them to), or Untitled Goose Game (where you control the elephants to do specific things), but as this is a game project, it is entirely up to your group to consider specific designs. If you bring a design to the initial pitch, you are more likely to score highly, so please do think about game design before the pitch session!

I am also leaving up to you whether you are interested in making this more simulation focused (i.e. realistic elephant behaviour) or more arcadey

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

(elephants behaving in ways that make the game fun). If you do want to build something more simulation-based we do know an elephant expert in the vet school.

Requirements

The group must provide a working game executable (probably built in a game engine such as Unity, Godot or Unreal Engine) which:

- 1) Has **elephants**. I really want elephants. Lots of them (or at least more than the number of players).
- 2) Identifies the relative position of multiple laptops using some kind of marker based calibration or room tracking solution; i.e. not using any external hardware. If you really must, I'll accept solutions that use a mobile phone to get positions. This is then used so everyone gets a different view of the **lovely elephants**.
- 3) Shows some kind of shared networked play-field which **has elephants on it**, and should be the same for everyone. Maybe this is a view onto an African savannah, or maybe you're envisaging what happens if a herd of elephants get lost in a major city, or your elephants have somehow got themselves onto a weird alien planet...
- 4) Is a puzzle game based on making the **elephants do things or get somewhere**. With at least some sample levels.
- 5) User documentation should be provided in the form of a tutorial.
- 6) It should have a good name. I've deliberately left this untitled for now.

If any of your team use a Mac please build it for Mac and PC and make sure it works cross platform. Same for Linux if anyone runs a linux laptop.

Note: As this is a CS project, while there's clearly some 3d skills required to build the project, we don't necessarily expect you to build all your own 3d assets; it is fine to use e.g. pre-built elephant or scenery 3d assets as long as they are credited in your work.

Note 2: Unless everyone on the team has a gaming laptop, I would recommend either Unity or Godot as your game engine over Unreal. Unreal is really hard to run on a normal laptop.

Skills

Highly desirable:

3d Game engines (Unity, Godot, Unreal, ...)

Game experience and interest (If no one on your team is a gamer, you

Desirable:

3d animation / 3d modelling.

Game design.

3d Graphics

probably don't want to do this project!)	Networking (although this may well be primarily handled by the game-engine)
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.